Something Happened Here

By Madeleine Martin

INTRODUCTION

BECKY: As children, we're taught that when we're hurt, we need to call for help
PAM: But what if you don't realize you're hurt?
BECKY: or can't admit that you're hurt?
PAM: Who will believe you
BECKY: when you don't even believe it yourself?
BOTH: "Something Happened Here"
PAM: by Madeleine Martin

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BECKY: *(Entering, followed closely by PAM)* I am so mad!

PAM: But you're sure you're OK?

BECKY: I said I'm OK, OK? I'm just ... I dunno ... mad. *(Pause)* I dunno.

PAM: Let's see if there's anything ta drink around here. Maybe it'd ... calm you down ... or somethin'. *(BECKY stares blankly at PAM. After a pause, PAM goes into the kitchen. From the kitchen)* Is there any whiskey or vodka in here? Becky? Where does Rob keep his booze? Becky? *(PAM returns to find BECKY just standing and staring.)* Becky!

BECKY: *(Jumping)* Whaaa ... Jeez, Pam! Don't sneak up behind me like that. What are ya tryin' ta do, anyway...

PAM: I wasn't sneaking. I was just askin' ya where Rob keeps his booze.

BECKY: Booze? Oh. I dunno. Check the tall cupboard. Beside the range. Or maybe the cupboard above the fridge. I dun no. *(PAM disappears into the kitchen again. BECKY sinks into a chair. She sighs heavily and drops her head into her hands.)*

PAM: *(Entering with a six-pack of beer)* Look what I found... Becky? Are you ...

BECKY: Don't. Do not ask me again or I swear I will scream. *(Seeing the beer)* Great. Beer. I shoulda known he'd only have beer in this place. Whatdaya expect from a grease monkey. Cars - and beer.

PAM: Hey, at least it's somethin'. Here. Have one.

BECKY: *(Reluctantly)* Thanks.

PAM: Whatsa matter? Do ya think he'll mind if we drink it?

BECKY: I don't know. I don't really care. And I don't think he'll care either. He ... "loves me," ya know? *(She slumps back and winces.)* Oh, ouch!

PAM: See? You are hurt! I knew it. Maybe we should call the hospital.

BECKY: Right! And tell 'em what?! Tell 'em ... Oh, you bet! *(She tries to open her beer.)*

PAM: My God, Beck, you're shakin' like a leaf. Gimme that. I'll open it for ya.

BECKY: I can open my own beer! *(BECKY twists the cap. It doesn't respond. She twists harder. Still nothing.)*

PAM: Maybe we should call the police.

BECKY: And tell em what?! "Come on over an open my beer?" Besides, what are *they* gonna do... now. I'm just... "very angry" - as my mom would say... that's all. *(The beer cap suddenly responds and some of the beer foams onto the carpet.)* Oooops! Sorry abut that, Rob. Got some beer on your carpet there! *(She smiles at PAM.)*

PAM: *(Sipping her beer)* I was so scared ... when you left, ya know? I didn't know what ta do.

BECKY: I don't wanna talk about it. It's over.

PAM: But it's so awful.

BECKY: Yeah, it's awful. But it's over. It was all a big mistake. A big filthy mistake.

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(She looks at her hands.) And my hands're filthy! *(She puts her beer down and goes into the kitchen to wash her hands.)*

PAM: I mean, Becky? Don't ya think ya should tell someone? I mean, maybe just call someone .., like, anonymously... or something?

BECKY: *(From the kitchen)* Just shut up, *Pam.* The last thing I need right now is to start makin' anonymous phone calls - from my boyfriend's house. *(She comes back into the room drying her hands.)* That would get everybody involved all over the place. My mother. My dad. *Your* mother. Think about it. What're we gonna tell 'em when they start sayin', "Well I thought you were spending the night at Pam's." "No, Pammy said they were spending the night at Becky's."

PAM: *(Looking at her beer. Quietly)* I know. It just seemed like a good plan, ya know, with Rob outta town and all. I mean, it's not like he's here or anything. And I thought there'd be a kegger or somethin'. It was all a dumb idea I guess.

BECKY: Yeah. Dumb. *(She sits and sips her beer.)* This stuff tastes like horse urine or something. I hate beer. Is it hot in here to you?

PAM: Hot?

BECKY: Or cold? Maybe it's cold in here. *(Pam stares silently at Becky.)* Or anything... maybe ... hot? It just doesn't... I dunno ... feel right. *(She begins to rock very gently.)* I stink. I should take a shower. And there must be somethin' on this bottle. My hands're sticky. *(She rises to go into the kitchen to wash her hands again.)*

PAM: There's nothin' on that bottle. Will you listen to me?

BECKY: *(Sitting again)* Listen to what?! Listen to you come up with some more good

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ideas?

PAM: I was so scared tonight!

BECKY: Yeah? So was I.

PAM: *(She nods. Looks at her bottle.)* Where did they take ya?

BECKY: They?

PAM: They. Him and that other guy?

BECKY: They? *(She stares of into space blankly.)* They.

PAM: Becky! There were two of them.

BECKY: Oh. Yeah. I dunno. He was ... his friend ... or somethin'. I dunno. I think he was drunk. I tried to wake him up. He was asleep ... or something ... but he wouldn't wake up.

PAM: He didn't *do* something? He didn't try to help you ...

BECKY: To help? No. No. He dropped him off at ... at a house ... somewhere. I didn't... I ... Well, why didn't *you* do something?!

PAM: *Me?* I wasn't even ...

BECKY: *(Rushing)* Yeah! You! Why didn't you "do something?" You could tell I didn't wanna go with 'em. Ya just stood there. Y'all just stood there! Nobody *did* anything. Y'all just stood there and watched us leave ... *(Suddenly calm)* I don't want to talk about it. *(She swallows a large gulp of beer.)*

PAM: *(Softly)* I'm sorry, Becky. I didn't know what ta do. Honest. I didn't.

BECKY: I'm sorry. I guess I just wasn't thinkin'. *(Silence)*

PAM: Oh, God, how did this happen?

BECKY: *Pam?* Please don't tell anybody. Ya gotta promise me that! *Please!*

PAM: Alright, alright! Relax! I'm not gonna tell anyone ...

BECKY: ... 'cause if you do, they'll find out! Everyone'll find out! My mother! *Your*

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mother! The police! And then what? Pam, ya gotta promise ...

PAM: *(Becoming seriously worried)* Alright, I said, I won't... ya gotta believe me. Relax, OK? Drink some more of your beer, OK? *(BECKY drinks. They are quiet for several moments.)*

BECKY: I was scared too, ya know.

PAM: I know.

BECKY: But it's not my fault.

PAM: Of course it's not your fault. Nobody would blame you for what happened. I don't! It's nobody's fault. It just happened.

BECKY: My father would blame me.

PAM: Your father?

BECKY: He would say, "Told ya not to go down there, didn't I? But ya had to go anyway. Well, it's your own fault and you deserve whatever you get!"

PAM: *(Quietly - under BECKY's lines)* Oh, Becky...

BECKY: *(Continuing without pausing)* And he's right - I shoulda never gone down there. He's always right ... I shouldn't have ... *(She pulls at her shirt collar.)* It's *hot* in here! *(Pam sees bruises that are growing quite red on BECKY's neck.)*

PAM: Oh my God, Becky... your neck... it's ...

BECKY: My neck? What... *(She goes to a mirror hung by the front door.)* Oh no! No way! Wait'll my mom sees that! Oh, she's gonna ...

PAM: See? You *are* hurt! *(Firmly)* Look, something happened here and you gotta tell someone.

BECKY: *(Absorbed in examining her bruises)* I'm ... not ... hurt ...really...

PAM: I got an idea. *(PAM picks up the phone book and scans the pages as BECKY*

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continues to examine her bruises.) I heard about this place... you can... call. It's...

BECKY: *(Still at the mirror)* It really happened? *(PAM stands and goes to BECKY She guides BECKY away from the mirror and leads BECKY back to her chair.)*

PAM: Look. This is stupid. You gotta tell someone. I heard about this place. You can talk to 'em. It's supposed ta be confidential.

BECKY: Confidential?

PAM: *(Smiling)* Yeah, confidential. It means they won't tell anyone. See? *(She looks closely at BECKY)* Never mind. I'll dial, you just talk. OK? Please? You're scarin' me!

BECKY: You dial.

PAM: *(Dials the phone and waits a moment.)* Here. It's ringing. *(PAM hand the phone to BECKY, who carefully puts the receiver up to her ear.)*

BECKY: What? *(Pause)* Oh, hello. Yes, I'm callin' to ... uh ... to ...

PAM: Please, Becky, *tell* them.

BECKY: *(Nodding)* Yeah, um, I'm callin' ... to talk ... to ... huh? *(Pause)* Yeah? Well, yeah ... I do. Um, somethin' happened here tonight and I guess I was ... raped? Uh-huh. Tonight ... I dunno ... about an hour ago?.. *(She looks at PAM questioningly. PAM looks at her watch and nods.)* Yeah, about an hour ago. Am I - what? Hurt? *(Again she looks at PAM, who looks expectantly back at BECKY)* Yeah, I'm here. No, I don't think I am. There's no blood anywhere. *(Suddenly she becomes agitated.)* No, I *can't* call the police! No. I can't... Hospital? No ... *(She looks at PAM.)* No, I... I can't. No, I'm OK...Look, just forget it... I gotta go now. Bye. *(She places the receiver gently in its*

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cradle.)

PAM: Well, what did they say?

BECKY: Well, she asked me if I was hurt, and I told her no, and she asked if I'd reported it, and I told her I couldn't, and she asked if I'd gone to the hospital, and I told her I couldn't ... *(She wipes her hands on her jeans.)*

PAM: Yeah? Go on. Wha'd she say ta do?

BECKY: *(Pausing)* She said that I should prob'ly have some tea and that I should prob'ly take a shower to, ya know, calm down? An' she said I could call her back later ta talk some more if I felt like it. But she said if I wasn't hurt then maybe I didn't need ta go ta the hospital...

PAM: No! No, way! Even I know better than that! Becky, if you wanna go ta the hospital, I'll drive ya there right now.

BECKY: No! Then everyone'll know and my dad'll kill me! I'm not goin'! I'm OK. Everything is OK. Ya gotta believe me.

PAM: OK. I believe you, OK? Nobody's gonna force ya to do anything you don't wanna do, OK? *(Silence)* Do you want another beer? *(Silence)* Look, maybe the lady was right. Maybe you should just take a nice hot shower and relax. Maybe that would feel good, OK? *(Silence)* I know. Look, I'll go start a shower for ya. OK? Do ya want me to start a shower for you?

BECKY: Yeah. Start a shower. That'd be good. Yeah.

PAM: OK. you just sit here real quiet, and I'll be right back ... OK?

BECKY: Yeah. OK. *(PAM leaves the room to go start BECKY's shower. Alone now, BECKY begins to rock again very slowly. She sips her beer. She looks at her hands. She takes a very long swig of beer and coughs a bit at the taste of it.)* Yeah. It's OK. Everything ... is OK. I'm not hurt.

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